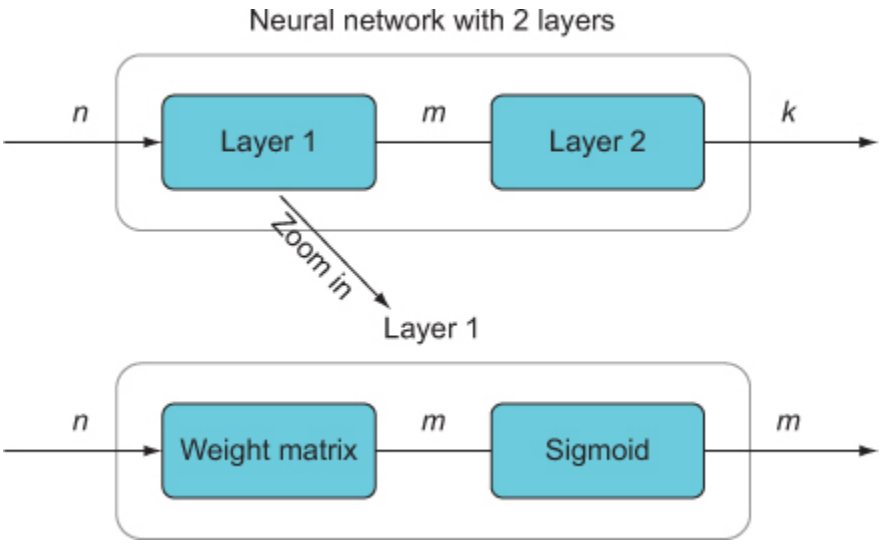


We will frequently use string diagrams throughout the book to communicate everything from complex mathematical equations to the architectures of deep neural networks. We will describe this graphical syntax in the next chapter, and we'll continue to refine and build it up throughout the rest of the book. In some cases, this graphical notation is overkill for what we're trying to explain, so we'll use a combination of clear prose and Python or pseudocode. We will also include traditional math notation in most cases, so you will be able to learn the underlying mathematical concepts one way or another, whether diagrams, code, or normal mathematical notation most connect with you.

1.8. What's next?

In the next chapter, we will dive right into the real meat of RL, covering many of the core concepts, such as the tradeoff between exploration and exploitation, Markov decision processes, value functions, and policies (these terms will make sense soon). But first, at the beginning of the next chapter we'll introduce some of the teaching methods we'll employ throughout the book.

The rest of the book will cover core DRL algorithms that much of the latest research is built upon, starting with deep Q-networks, followed by policy gradient approaches, and then model-based algorithms. We will primarily